

ADD A HOOD

TO ANY KNITTING PATTERN

Workbook and Inspiration for Machine Knitters



TABLE OF CONTENTS

Introduction.....	3
Considerations for Machine Knitters	4
4 Basic Hood Styles.....	5
Compare Styles.....	7
Basic Measurements	8
✓ Simple Rectangle.....	9
SHAPED Rectangular Hood.....	12
✓ Sideways Rectangle.....	14
SHAPED Sideways Rectangle Version	17
✓ QUICK 'N EASY HOOD.....	19
SHAPED Quick 'n Easy Version	21
✓ T-shaped hood	23
SHAPED T-Shaped Hood.....	26
Finishing Suggestions.....	27
Hand finishing Tips	27
Machine finishing Tips.....	28
Get creative!	29
Removable hood	30
Soften the Point	31
Decorative hoods vs practical hoods	33
TWO options for a larger hood	33
Conclusion	36
Other Ebooks from Knit it Now.....	37



INTRODUCTION



Adding a hood adds a practical designer touch to any sweater. You don't need to search for a machine knitting pattern with a hood ... create your own!

Use this book as a workbook for knitting your own hoods. To get started add a simple rectangle to a crew neck sweater. Once you understand the different hood styles, add hoods to v-necks and lower round neck sweaters.

Make your hood a design feature or create a large, roomy practical addition for warmth.



ARMED WITH A LITTLE INFORMATION, THERE IS NO REASON WHY A KNITTER CAN'T ADD A HOOD TO ANY KNITTING PATTERN.

THE HARDEST PART IS DECIDING THE SHAPE OF THE HOOD AND HOW IT'S GOING TO BE ATTACHED.



CONSIDERATIONS FOR MACHINE KNITTERS

As machine knitters, there are some considerations we need to keep in mind when planning a hood.

Available needles on the bed	If the neckline of your sweater is deep, you may not have enough needles to pick up the hood in one piece. Consider a "Sideways" hood.
Garment shape: Pullover or cardigan	You may choose to pick up around the neckline of a cardigan to attach the hood as you knit it. With a flatbed knitting machine, this isn't possible for pullovers. Knit the hood first, then attach it to the neckline.
Hood shape: Decorative or functional	Create a simple rectangle hood as a variation on a collar. It may never be worn over the head, but adds a designer touch to your design. If you will need the warmth of a hood, consider shaping the hood to fully cover the ears and head.
Finishing techniques: Hand knitting or machine	Determine your finishing choice before knitting the garment. Depending on the style of your hood, you can add a simple hung hem or a decorative hem treatment for the edge around the face. Our favorite finish is to pick up the hood edge and the garment front edges at one time and hand knit a band. Consider knitting a long, skinny band and attaching it to the edges. Crochet can be beautiful as well.

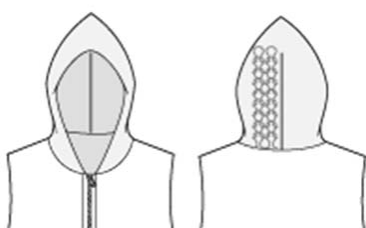
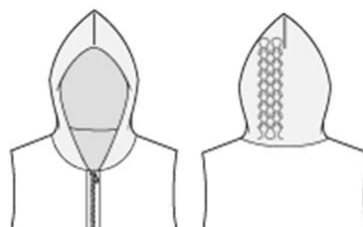


4 BASIC HOOD STYLES

- **Simple Rectangle Hood**

Easy to knit rectangular hood that is picked up and knit from a cardigan neckline or knit separately and stitched by hand to a pullover neckline. Suitable for a crew neckline.

A seam is in the center front of the hood.



- **Simple Sideways Knit Hood**

Knit sideways, this style can be used when there aren't enough needles available to pick up the neckline. It also can be used to continue a stitch pattern from the garment front "up and over" the hood.

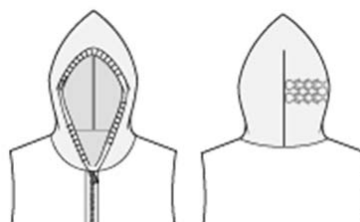
This style has a seam in the center back

- **Quick 'n Easy Hood**

Easy to knit rectangular hood that is started from the edge around the face, then knit and attached to the neckline.

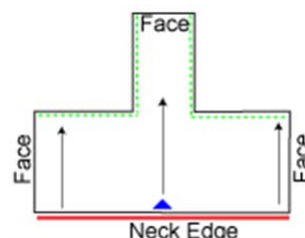
Work ribbing, hung hem or edge finish as desired, then complete the hood.

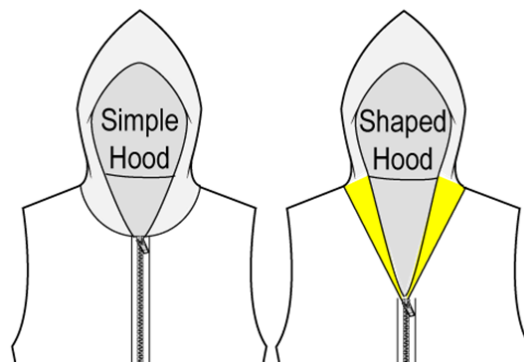
A seam is in the center back.



- **T-shaped hood**

The T-Shape gives improved fit and no point





A **simple rectangular hood** is perfect for a crew neck sweater.

If the sweater has a V-neck or a lower round neck, the hood will need a bit of shaping.

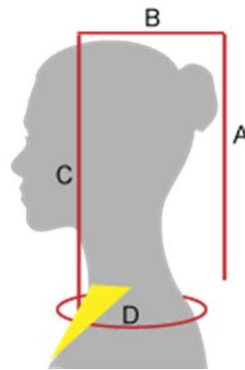
Beginning machine knitters:

Knit the rectangular hoods for crew necks.

Advanced knitters:

The shaped hoods involve short row shaping to create the “V” shape

NOTE: We will be using cardigan sweater shapes for this workbook – the ideas and techniques are similar for pullovers ... instead of picking up the neckline stitches (difficult on a flatbed machine), knit your hood shape to fit the opening and stitch it in place by hand.



COMPARE STYLES

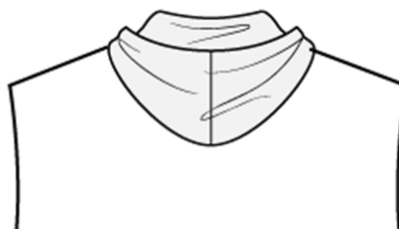
Adding a hood to a knitting pattern can be as simple as picking up the neck edge and knitting a rectangle long enough to cover the head. Seam up one edge of the rectangle, finish the edges and Voila!

Other construction methods re-orient the seam, to allow for needle bed limitations, and to accommodate stitch patterning.

We will discuss the construction of each of these styles in detail.



	Face edge	Neck Edge	Seam	Enough Needles?
SIMPLE RECTANGLE	Finish separately	Pick up the full neck edge	Center top at face	Neck opening
SIDEWAYS	Finish Separately	Pick up half neck edge	Center back	½ neck opening
QUICK 'N EASY	Decorative cast on knit first	Cast on – join neck edge separately	Center Back	Hood height x 2 (24")
T- SHAPE	Finish Separately	Pick up full neck edge	2 seams at center front	Neck opening



BASIC MEASUREMENTS

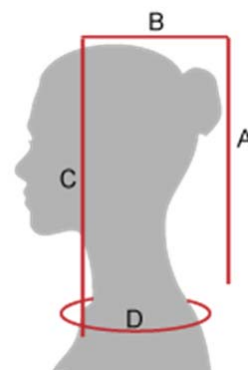
A. Head Height at Back

Place a ruler or a book at the top of the head. Measure down to the neck opening of the sweater. An adult hood is 12-14".

B. Hood Depth

Place the back of the head against a wall. Measure from the wall to the desired place on the side of the face. Add a bit of ease for comfort.

For a decorative hood that is intended to be more of a collar, this dimension could be the same as the neck opening dimension.

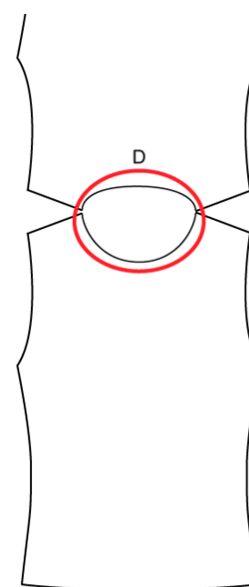


C. Head Height at Front

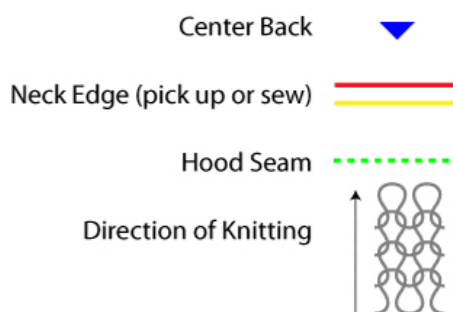
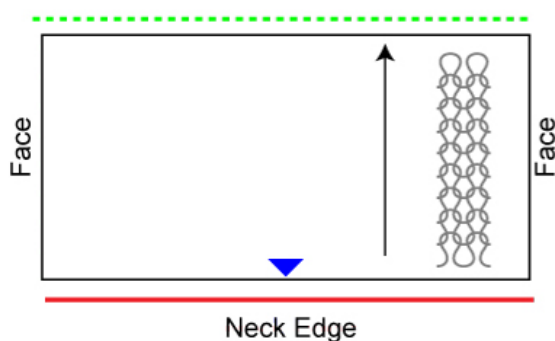
If the sweater has a V-neck or lower front neck edge, extra length will need to be added.

D. Neck opening

Use the dimensions from your knitting pattern schematic or measure your finished sweater to determine the size of your garment neck opening



LEGEND

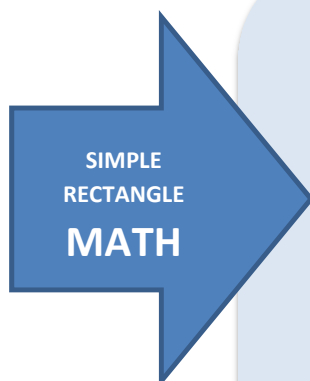
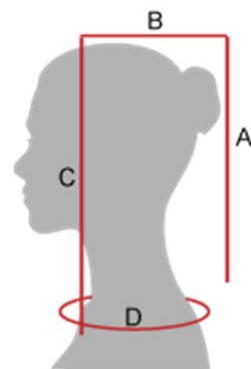
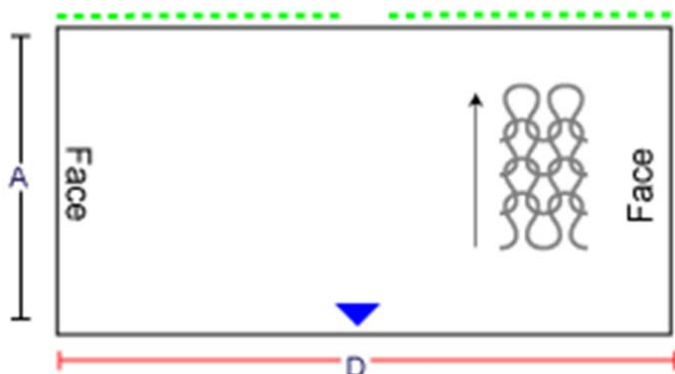


✓ SIMPLE RECTANGLE

This style is an easy-to-knit rectangular hood that is picked up and knit from a cardigan neckline or knit separately and stitched by hand to a pullover neckline. It is suitable for a crew neckline. A seam is in the center front of the hood.

FEATURES	CONSIDER
Fast and easy knitting – just a rectangle!	Do you have enough needles on your needlebed?
Use any stitch pattern	Consider direction of knitting for stripes an horizontal stitch patterns.
	Seam at the center front
	Pointed top
	Finish front edge last





	Yours	Example
Stitch Gauge in Inches		7 sts = 1"
Row Gauge in Inches		11 rows = 1"
Measure the sweater neck opening D in inches		22"
Multiply D by your STITCH Gauge		22 x 7 = 154sts
Determine the length of the hood (A) in inches		12"
Multiply A by your ROW Gauge		12 x 11 = 132 rows

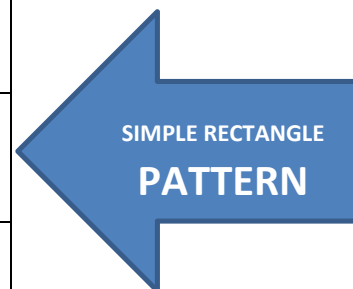


www.knititnow.com/tools

Use the Knit it Now
Rectangle/Square Tools



SIMPLE RECTANGLE PATTERN	Yours	Example
With wrong side facing, pickup D stitches along neck edge		154 sts
Knit in pattern for A rows		132 rows
Remove stitches on waste yarn Fold the hood in half and join the top seam. Suggested Neckline Finish: Pick up the center front edges, around the hood front edge with a circular hand knitting needle to finish. See Finishing Suggestions for more options.		



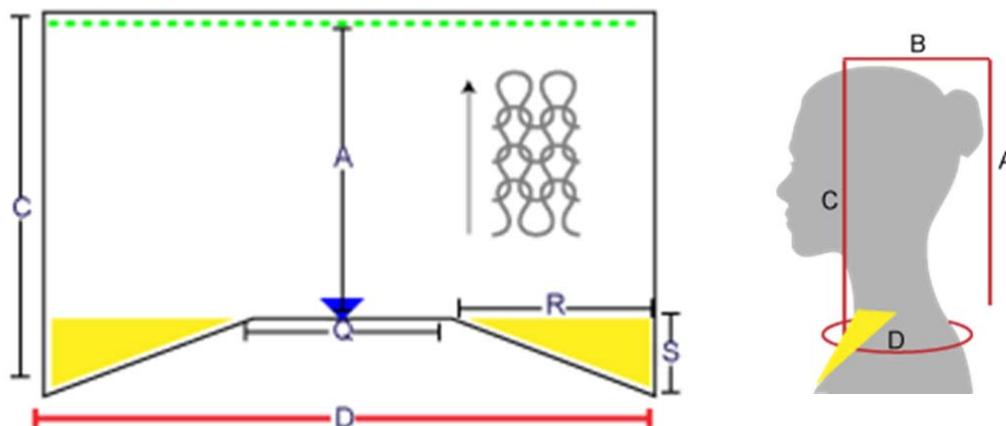
Remove the hood on waste yarn and Kitchener stitch for an invisible seam



SHAPED RECTANGULAR HOOD

A simple rectangular hood is perfect for a crew neck sweater.

If the Head Height at the front **C** is longer than the back, the hood will need a bit of shaping. Shaping is needed to accommodate a v-neck or lower round neck sweater neckline.



SHAPED RECTANGLE MATH

		Yours	Example
Stitch Gauge in Inches			7 sts = 1"
Row Gauge in Inches			11 rows = 1"
Neck Opening (sts)	D		22" x 7 = 154 sts
Head Height Back (rows)	A		12" x 11 = 132 rows
Head Height Front (rows)	C		16" x 11 = 176 rows
Center Back Neck (sts)	Q		9" x 7 = 63 stitches
Head height Front rows MINUS Head Height Back rows	C – A = S		176-132 = 44 rows
Front Neck Opening	(D-Q)/2= R		154-63=91 91/2 = 45



SHAPED HOOD PATTERN (for v necklines)	Yours	Example
With wrong side facing, pickup D stitches along neck edge		154 sts
Carriage on the Right		
Set carriage to hold Position		
Place all needles in hold position		
On the right edge, short row increase R stitches over S Rows (use the Magic Formula www.knititnow.com/tools to determine the increases)		45 sts over 44 rows 2sts every other row 22 times
End with the carriage on the right. Cancel hold		
Knit across ALL needles		
Carriage on the left.		
Set carriage to hold		
Place all needles in hold position		
Short row increase on the left edge mirroring the right side.		2sts every other row 22 times
Put all needles into work		
Set Row counter to 000		
Knit in pattern for A rows		132 Rows
Remove stitches on waste yarn Fold the hood in half and join the top seam. Kitchener Stitch the live stitches for an invisible join. Suggested Finish: Finish the sweater and hood front edges with 2 rows of double crochet. See Finishing Suggestions for more options.		

SHAPED RECTANGLE
PATTERN

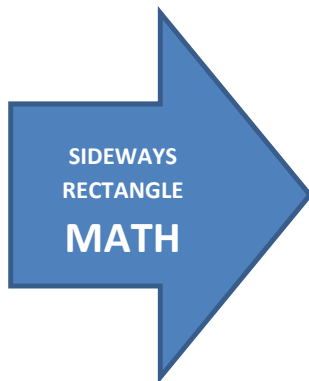
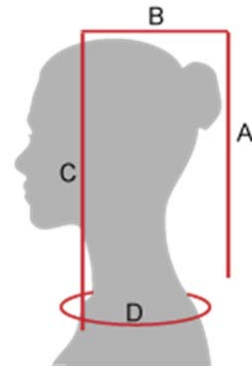
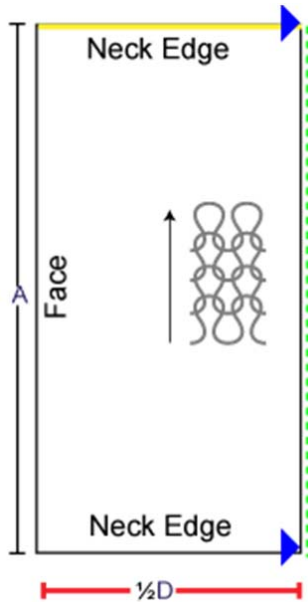


✓ SIDEWAYS RECTANGLE

Knit sideways, this style can be used when there aren't enough needles available to pick up the neckline or you want to continue a stitch pattern from the garment fronts. This hood has a seam in the center back.

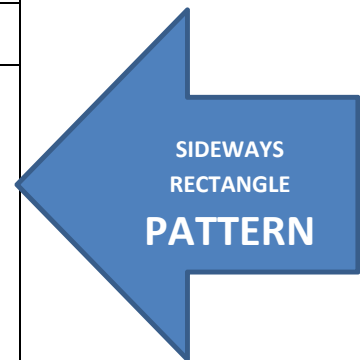
FEATURES	CONSIDER
No seam at the center front	Seam at the center back
Fast and easy knitting – just a rectangle!	
Use any stitch pattern	Consider the direction of knitting for stripes and horizontal stitch patterns
Good for large neck openings	Pointed top
Continue stitch patterning from garment front	Finish front edge last



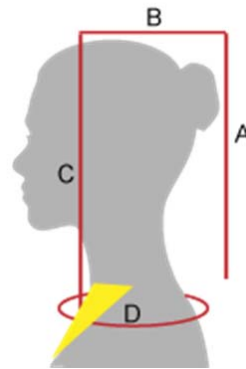
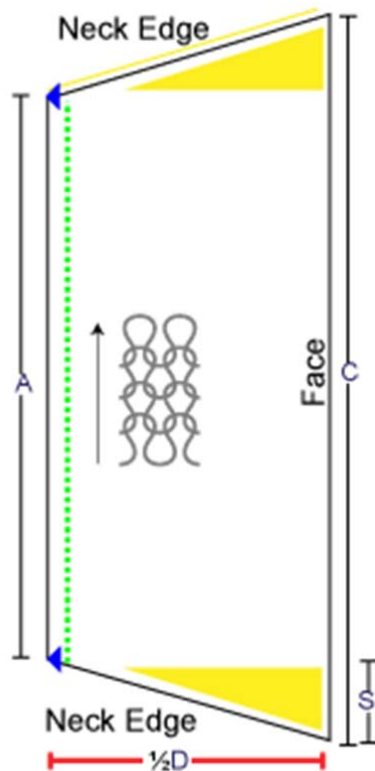


		Yours	Example
Stitch Gauge in Inches			7 sts = 1"
Row Gauge in Inches			11 rows = 1"
Measure the neck opening in inches	D		22"
Divide D by 2			$22/2 = 11"$
Multiply D/2 by your STITCH Gauge			$11 \times 7 = \mathbf{77 \text{ sts}}$
Determine the total length of the hood A in inches (from shoulder to shoulder over the head)	A		24"
Multiply A by your ROW Gauge			$24 \times 11 = 264 \text{ rows}$

SIDEWAYS RECTANGLE PATTERN	Yours	Example
Cast on D/2 Stitches. This edge will attach to ½ of the neckline, from center front to center back.		77 sts
Knit in pattern for A Rows		264 rows
Bind off or remove on waste yarn Fold hood in half and neatly join center back seam Attach neckline edges to the sweater. Finish the front edges of the hood as desired See Finishing Suggestions for more options.		



SHAPED SIDEWAYS RECTANGLE VERSION



SHAPED
SIDEWAYS
RECTANGLE
MATH

		Yours	Example
Stitch Gauge in Inches			7 sts = 1"
Row Gauge in Inches			11 rows = 1"
Neck Opening (sts)	$D / 2$		22" / 2 = 11" 11" x 7 = 77sts
Back Height (rows)	A		24" x 11 = 264 rows
Front Height (rows)	C		32" x 11 = 352 rows
Head height Front MINUS Head Height Back	$C - A = S$ (rows)		352 - 264 = 88 rows
Neck Shaping	$S / 2$		88 / 2 = 44 rows



SHAPED SIDEWAYS HOOD PATTERN (for V necklines)		Yours	Example
Cast on D/2 Stitches. This edge will attach to ½ of the neckline, from center front to center back.	D/2		77sts
Knit 1 row and put all needles in hold position			
Short row INCREASE D/2 stitches over S / 2 Rows (use the Magic Formula www.knititnow.com/tools to determine the increases)	S / 2		77 sts over 44 rows
Knit in pattern for A rows	A		264 rows
Put all needles in hold position			
Short Row DECREASE to mirror the beginning shaping			77 sts over 44 rows
Bind off or remove on waste yarn Attach neckline edges to the sweater. Fold hood in half and neatly join center back seam Finish the front edges of the hood as desired See Finishing Suggestions for more options.			

SHAPED
SIDEWAYS
RECTANGLE
PATTERN



www.knititnow.com/tools

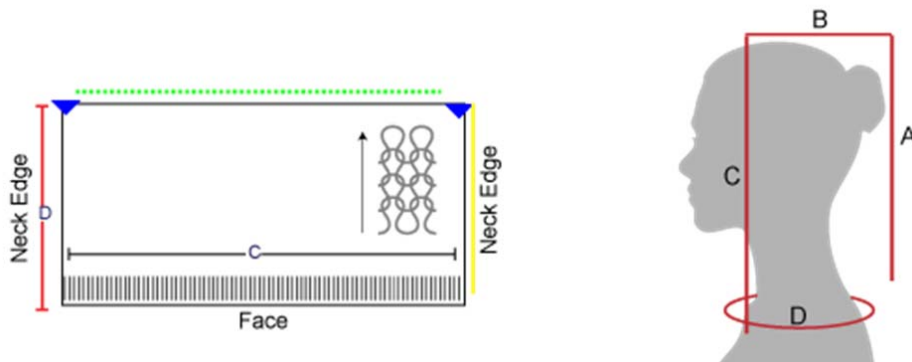
*Use the Knit it Now
Magic Formula Tools.*



✓ QUICK 'N EASY HOOD

Knit from the face, this style allows you to finish the front edge first, then continue to knit the hood. Easily add a hem and a drawstring, knit ribbing or a decorative hem.

FEATURES	CONSIDER
Front edge finishing is worked first	Hood is knit separately, seamed, then joined to the garment.
	Center Back seam
	Do you have enough needles on your needlebed?

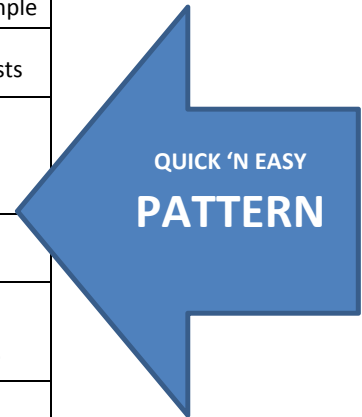


QUICK 'N EASY MATH

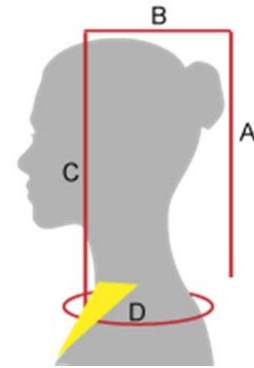
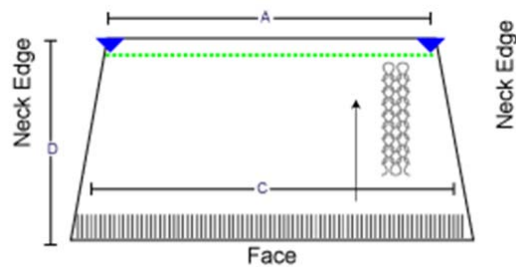
		Yours	Example
Stitch Gauge in Inches			7 sts =1"
Row Gauge in Inches			11 rows=1"
Measure the Head height A at front in inches (from shoulder to shoulder over the head)	A		24"
Multiply A by your STITCH Gauge			24 x 7 =168 sts
Determine the neck opening D in inches	D		22"
Multiply $\frac{1}{2}$ D by your ROW Gauge	$\frac{1}{2}$ D		22"/2= 11" 11" x 11 121 rows



QUICK 'N EASY HOOD PATTERN		Yours	Example
Cast on A Stitches.	A		168 sts
Work ribbing, hung hem or edge finish of your choice. This is the front edge of the hood			
Reset Row Counter to 000			
Knit $\frac{1}{2}$ D rows in pattern (this is $\frac{1}{2}$ of the neck opening)	$\frac{1}{2}$ D		121 rows
Scrap off Fold hood in half and neatly join center back seam Neatly stitch hood to garment See Finishing Suggestions for more options			



SHAPED QUICK 'N EASY VERSION

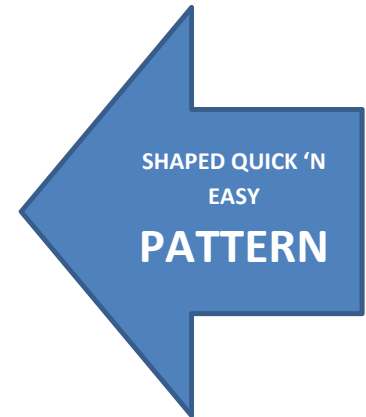


SHAPED QUICK 'N EASY MATH

		Yours	Example
Stitch Gauge in Inches			7 sts = 1"
Row Gauge in Inches			11 rows = 1"
Calculate the Head height C at front in stitches (from shoulder to shoulder over the head)	C		24" x 7 = 168 sts
Calculate the Head height A at back in stitches (from shoulder to shoulder over the head)	A		32" x 7 = 224 sts
C - A = Q	Q		224 - 168 = 56 sts
Determine the neck opening D in inches	D		22"
Multiply $\frac{1}{2}$ D by your ROW Gauge	$\frac{1}{2}$ D		22" / 2 = 11" 11" x 11 121 rows



Quick 'n Easy Shaped Hood		Yours	Example
Cast on C Stitches.	C		168 sts
Work ribbing, hung hem or edge finish of your choice. This is the front edge of the hood			
Reset Row Counter to 000			
Along both edges, decrease Q stitches over $\frac{1}{2}$ D rows (use the Magic Formula www.knititnow.com/tools to determine the increases)			56 sts over 121 rows (28 stitches each side)
Scrap off Fold hood in half and neatly join center back seam Neatly stitch hood to garment See Finishing Suggestions for more options.			



✓ T-SHAPED HOOD

With a bit more shaping, this style eliminates the point of rectangular hood styles. As a design element, carry a vertical stitch pattern up from the back of the sweater to the top of the head.

FEATURES	CONSIDER
No pointed head	Extra seams to join
Design opportunities (carry vertical stitch pattern from garment to hood front)	2 seams at the center front
Use any Stitch Pattern	Consider stripes and horizontal stitch patterns that will travel up the "T" section.
	Finish front edge last



T- Shape

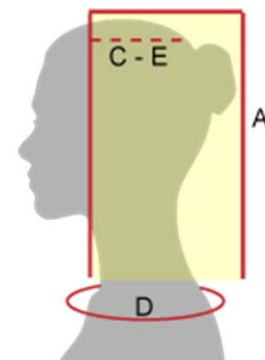
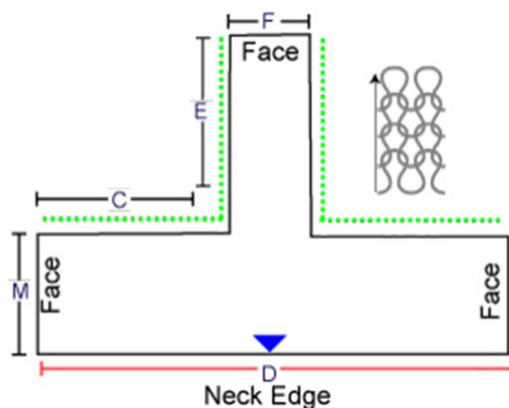
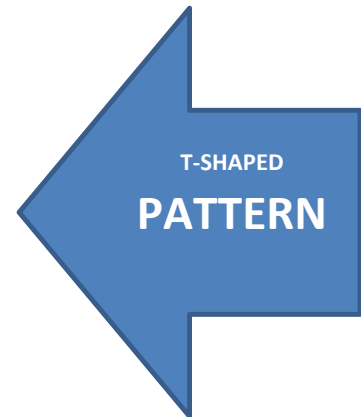
MATH

		Yours	Example
Stitch Gauge in Inches			7 sts =1"
Row Gauge in Inches			11 rows=1"
Neck Edge D	D Inches	"	22"
Neck Edge D times stitch gauge	D Stitches	sts	22"x 7 =154 sts
Hood Height A	A Inches	"	12"
Hood Height A Times row gauge	A Rows	rows	12 x 11 =132 rows
T shape 3" (adult) 2" (child)	F Inches	"	3"
T shape Times stitch gauge	F Stitches	sts	3"x 7 = 22 sts
Face inches M (A inches minus $\frac{1}{2}$ F inches)	M inches	"	12" – 1.5" =10.5"-
Face rows M M times Row gauge	M Rows	rows	10.5" x 11 =116 rows
Hood Seam C (D inches – F inches)/2	C inches	"	(22" – 3" = 19)/2 =9.5"
Hood Seam C C inches times stitch gauge	C stitches	sts	9.5*7 =66sts
Hood Seam E (C inches times row gauge)	E Rows		9.5 * 11 = 104 rows

- Establish the inch dimensions first, then work the math.
- Round up, when working stitch and row calculations.
- The dimension of C and E must match. These seams are joined.
- The measurements M+M+F equals the hood height times 2

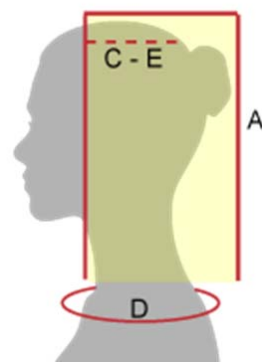
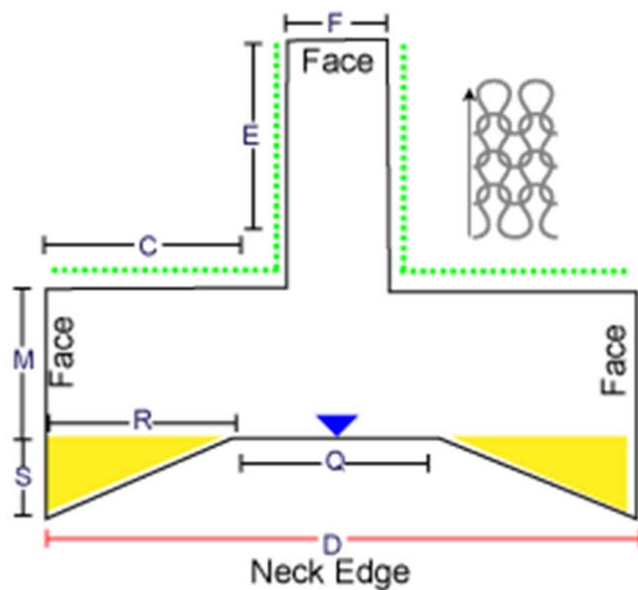


T-Shaped Hood (no point)	Yours	Example
Cast on D Stitches		154 sts
Knit for M Rows		116 rows
On the right side, bind off C stitches		66 sts
Knit 1 row		
On the left side, bind off C stitches		66 sts
F stitches remain		22 sts
Knit across F stitches for E rows		104 rows
Bind off F stitches		22 sts
Join Green seam lines to form T shaped hood Attach hood to garment neck edge Finish front edge as desired		



SHAPED T-SHAPED HOOD

1. Calculate the neck shaping as the Shaped Rectangular Hood
2. Continue to calculate the T-shaped Hood as above



FINISHING SUGGESTIONS

HAND FINISHING TIPS



Ribbing



Garter/Seed Stitch



Crochet

MACHINE FINISHING TIPS

Unless you are making an infant cardigan you probably won't be able to pick up the entire neck edge and knit a band on the machine.

You could work it in 2 sections, with a neat seam at the back, but remember this seam will show at the forehead on the finished sweater.



Knit a Separate Band

- Knit a narrow full needle rib (or ribbed) band long enough to go around both fronts and the entire hood opening.
- End with waste yarn.
- Hand stitch in place and finish the waste yarn edge to match the cast on edge.



Sew-as-you-go I-Cord

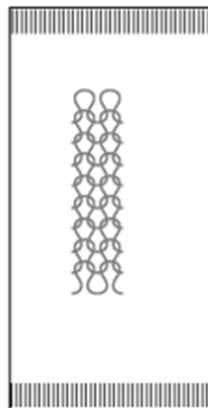
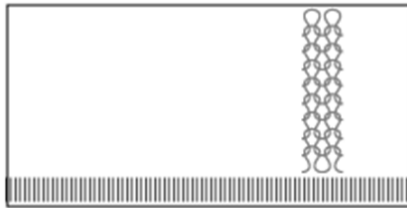
- Work a 3 or 4 stitch I-Cord around the front edges of the sweater, attaching the cord as you go. (Right side facing)
- Add button loops as you knit



GET CREATIVE!

Consider that you are basically knitting a rectangle. No matter what direction you knit, The design possibilities are endless!

- Horizontal and vertical stripes of color
- Directional stitch patterns
- Embellishments
- Make the front edge a design feature
- Combine hand knitting, machine knitting and crochet
- Add a pompom
- Add a hood to a Poncho, Ruana, or Scarf



CONSIDER KNITTING A HOOD
IN

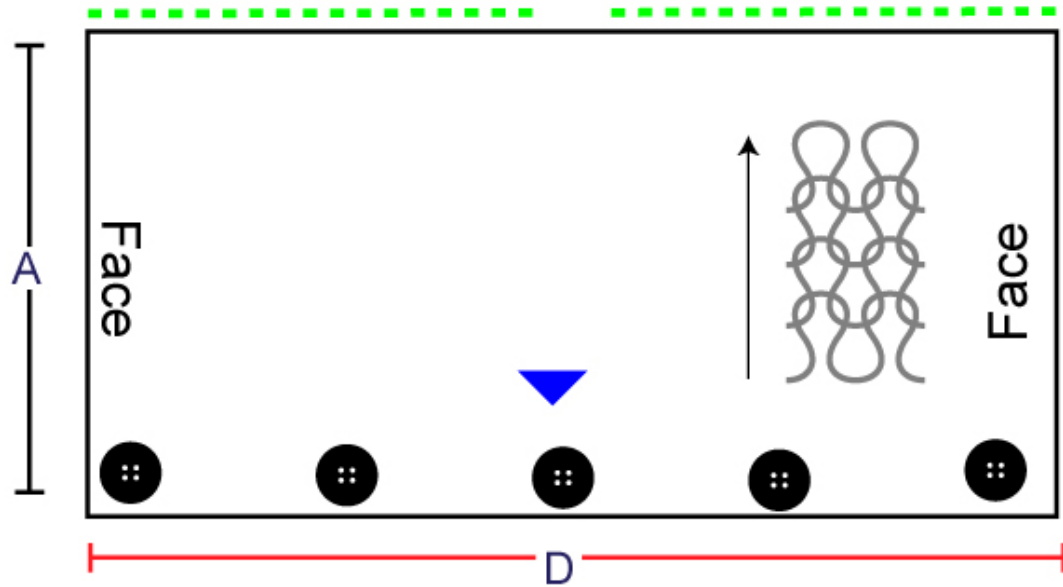
A DIFFERENT STITCH
PATTERN

THAN THE GARMENT



REMOVABLE HOOD

- Use any of the hood styles and knit them separately. Plan and add buttonholes along the neck edge of the hood.
- Finish the sweater with a neckband
- Add buttons to the neckband to attach the hood



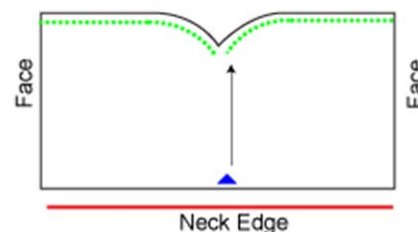
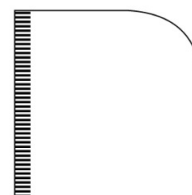
SOFTEN THE POINT

Adding a pompom to a pointed hood may be adorable for a little one. An adult would appreciate a softer shape to the top of the hood. The T-Shape hood completely eliminates the point.

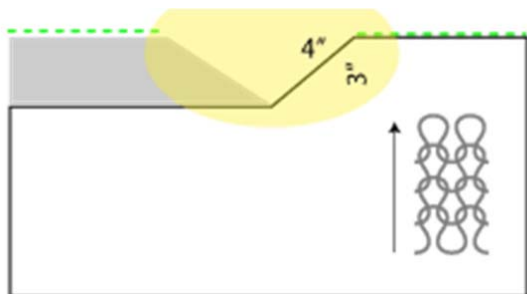
The other hood shapes can be modified to soften the point with a bit of shaping.

Calculate the half way point of the seam edge (green dotted lines) of your hood

Use the Magic Formula to calculate the rate of shaping.



Simple Rectangle and Quick 'N Easy hoods



For an adult, stop knitting 3" before the end of the hood.

Put $\frac{1}{2}$ the needles in hold position.

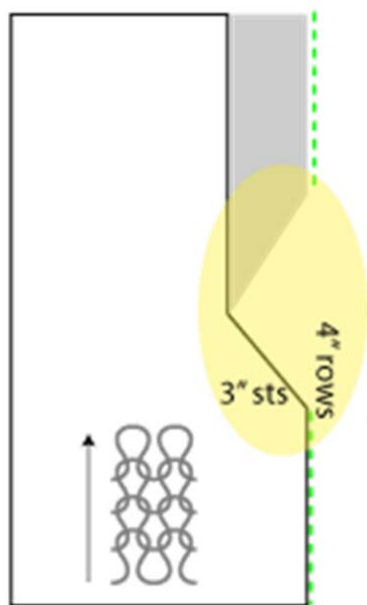
Using the Magic Formula calculate decreases of 4" of stitches over 3" of rows

Bind off the first side

Return the other side to working position and mirror the decreases just worked.

Bind off the second side.

Sideways Hood



Knit $\frac{1}{2}$ the hood width MINUS 8" of rows

Using the Magic Formula, calculate and decrease 3" of stitches over 4" of rows

Mirror the shaping by increasing back to the original stitch count.

Continue knitting the required number of rows for the hood width.



www.knititnow.com/tools

Use the Knit it Now
Magic Formula Tools.

DECORATIVE HOODS VS PRACTICAL HOODS

The size of all of the hoods we've discussed are based on the neck opening. For a decorative collar/hood this should be enough width to cover the wearer's head and ears.

TWO OPTIONS FOR A LARGER HOOD

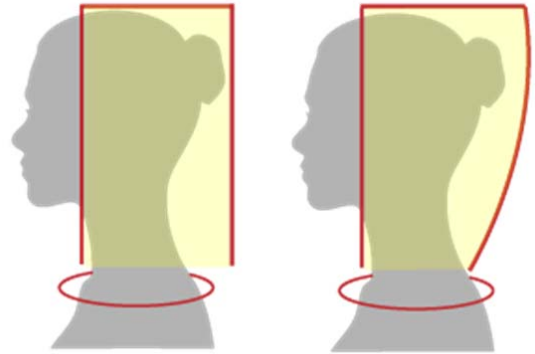
For a more practical hood, you may want to make the body of the hood wider.

1. Increase the hood width after picking up

One way to accomplish this is to increase the width of the hood immediately after picking it up from the neck edge. Hand knitters are instructed to "increase X stitches even across the row".

Translated for machine knitters:

- Remove the work from the machine with a garter bar or waste yarn
- Rehang the work, increasing stitches evenly across the row
- Knit 1 row
- Repeat as needed to obtain the desired hood width.



2. Increase the hood width as you knit

Because method 1 is tedious on the knitting machine, consider gently shape the hood as shown in the diagrams below

Simple Rectangle and Quick 'n Easy Hoods

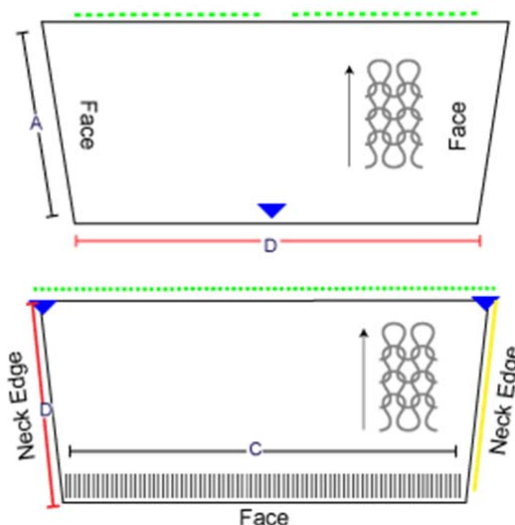
Establish the desired size of the hood.

Increase stitches from cast on edge to bind off edge.

Use the Magic Formula to determine the rate of increases

~or~

Use the Knit it Now Magic Formula tools to determine the rate of increases



Sideways Hood

Cast on neck edge stitches

Short row increase the desired amount of increased hood width

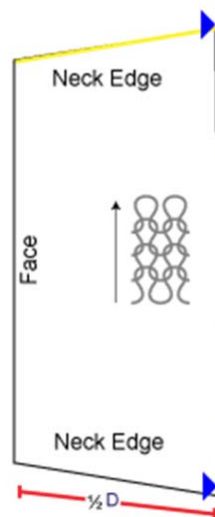
Knit the body of the hood

Short Row decrease to match initial increases

Use the Magic Formula to calculate

~or~

Use the Knit it Now Slope Tool to determine the rate of the shaping



T-shape

Cast on the neck edge stitches

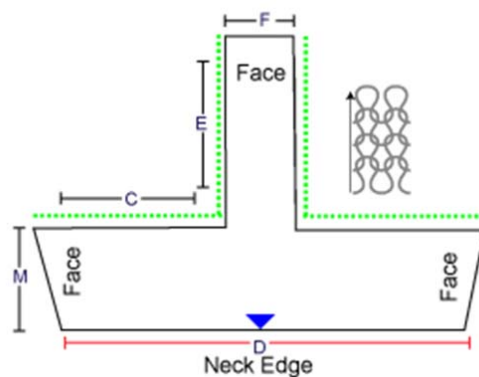
Increase the desired width of the hood

Lengthen the "E" dimension to ensure the C and E dimensions are equal.

Use the Magic Formula to determine the rate of increases

~or~

Use the Knit it Now Magic Formula tools to determine the rate of increases



CONCLUSION

Whether you are drafting your knitting pattern by hand or adding a hood to an existing pattern, you can make it your own with just a little bit of math following these examples.

If you dislike math Use the Knit it Now hood tools to create your hood

Enter in your gauge and dimensions and let the tool do the math.



www.knititnow.com/tools

Use the Knit it Now
Hood Tools

Knit

[Projects](#) / [Patterns](#) / [The Basics](#) / [Stitch Library](#) / [Tools](#) / [Sizing](#) / [Vintage Yarn Index](#)

My Pattern Library

Hoods

Create a simple hood shape for any pattern. Enter the dimensions of your finished neck opening and the desired hood depth. The tool will generate a hood pattern based on your stitch and row gauge

One Inch

4 Inch / 10 cm

Stitch gauge

Row gauge

Neck Edge D

(inches)

Height A

(inches)

Select A Hood Type

Simple Rectangle

Sideways Rectangle

Quick 'N Easy

T Shaped



OTHER EBOOKS FROM KNIT IT NOW

www.KnitItNow.com/KIN_BOOKS

